

You've Lost Mail...?

Q I upgraded to Windows XP from 98. My Outlook Express mails and address book are missing.

Aatish Thadani

A This happens only when you install XP in a location that is different from that of the previous version of Windows. Nevertheless, your e-mails and address book can be retrieved.

First, find your previous mail messages. On your Desktop, create a new folder called OldMail. If you use Identities, create a new folder for each identity. Start a search for all files and folders, and under the All or part of the file name option, type *.dbx. Under More advanced options, choose Search hidden files and folders.

Note that if you had previously used identities, each user will have his own Identity folder. Each of these will have a unique alphanumeric number (for example, {9EFEBDEA-CE00-4DD7-A4D6-CDB85C3EEDBF}) followed by "\Microsoft\Outlook Express".

Copy the old mail folders to the OldMail folder. Make sure to include the Folders.dbx file when you copy the folders. This file is necessary for the import function in Outlook Express. Perform this procedure for each Identity folder, but make sure to create a separate folder for each identity folder you find.

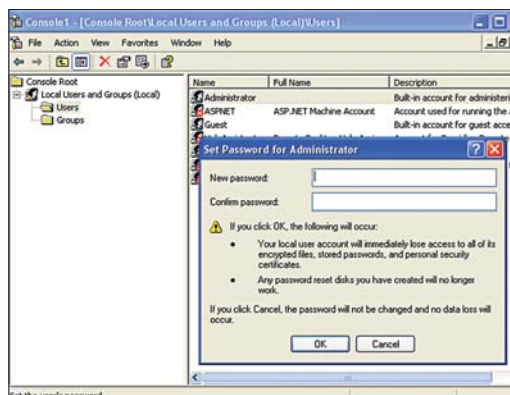
Then, Import your mail and folders. Open Outlook Express. Select File > Import. Click Messages. Click

Microsoft Outlook Express 5, and then Next. In some instances you may only see the options to import from Outlook Express 4 and Outlook Express 6. If your previous version of Outlook Express was version 4, use the option for Outlook Express 4. If you are importing from Outlook Express 5 or 5.5, you can use the Outlook Express 6 option. Click Import mail from an OE6 store directory, and click OK. Click Browse, select the OldMail folder, click OK, and then Next. Click All folders, and then Next. This procedure imports your previous mail into the current Identity. After this is done, click Finish. Repeat this procedure for each of the folders you created earlier.

Now find Your Windows Address Book. Start a search for all files and folders. In the What do you want to search for box, click All files and folders. Under All or part of the file name, type *.wab, and click Search. When the search is done, double-click each file to open it. When you find the correct one (it will contain your Contacts), note the location and name of the file.

Now import your Windows Address Book: in OE, select File > Import, and then click Address Book. Point the Look In field to the location you noted. Click the .wab file and then Open. Click OK, and the Address Book will be imported.

After you have verified that the import was successful, remove all the folders you created during the mail recovery process.



The Microsoft Management Console for when you need to set the Admin password

Start the Microsoft Management Console (Start > Run > mmc), and start the Local Users and Groups snap-in. To do this, go to File > Add/Remove Snap-in, click on Add in the Standalone tab, select Local Users and Groups, and go through Add > Finish > Close > OK. Under Console Root, expand Local Users and Groups, and then click Users. In the right pane, right-click Administrator, and click Set Password. Click Proceed in the message box that appears. Type and confirm the new password in the appropriate boxes. Click OK.

No SP2, No Problem

Q I am a programmer. I've found that my Windows XP Pro computer takes considerably longer to compile programs and access files from the network than it took when I was using Windows NT on the same hardware.

Samir Ahmed

A This is a documented problem; installing Service Pack 2 will fix it. If you are unable to install Service Pack 2 for some reason, here is a workaround.

1. Map a network drive to the SMB server. Follow these steps to do this:

Start Windows Explorer. On the Tools menu, click Map Network Drive. In the Drive list, click a drive letter. Then in the Folder list, type the UNC path of the shared resource on the server. Use the following format:

\\ServerName\SharedItem

Alternatively, click Browse, and then locate the shared resource. Click Finish.

2. Disable NetBT on a network interface. Do the following:

Run ncpa.cpl. Right-click the network connection you want to configure, and click Properties. If the connection is a local area connection, click the General tab, click Internet Protocol (TCP/IP) in the This connection uses the following items box, and click Properties. If the connection is not a local area connection, click the Networking tab. Click Advanced, and then the WINS tab. In the NetBIOS settings area, click Disable NetBIOS over TCP/IP. Click OK thrice.

3. Add the ScavengerTimeLimit value to the Registry:

In the Registry Editor, locate the key called HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\MRXSmb\Parameters

Right-click on Parameters, go to New, and click DWORD value. Name it ScavengerTimeLimit. Double-click